



A MONTH OF CHAITRA

ART EXHIBITION

A Small WORLD

From the bylanes of Nathdwara and the tradition-laden streets of Udaipur and Pune, Studio Napean brings a collection of miniature paintings that is set to enthrall audiences. Showcasing the evolving nature of miniature art, the gallery brings together over 100 pieces by 35 artists from across the sub-continent. From the Pahari style of Himachal Pradesh to the popular Mughal miniatures, artists like Mahesh Sharma from Nathdwara, Khubi Lal Sharma from Udaipur, Vijay Sharma from Himachal Pradesh and Shrikant Pradhan from Pune follow the evolution of the miniature art form through dynasties. Their works move through various phases of mythology—the Ragamala series, the Bara-masas, Rasikapriya, Gita Govinda, the Krishna Leela portraits and Lord Shrinath. At Studio Napean, Mumbai, till April 30.

by Swati Mathur

MUSIC REVIEW

Beats of the Past

It's almost as if the notes have drifted in from the bygone era into the 21st century. With several launches of archival recordings of classical music, there is a sense of expectation among students and connoisseurs alike. The antique tones are not only a barometer of the changes that have come into classical music over the years, but also recall a lost era of a technically purer form of music. The *Great Maestros* series features Ustad Nissar Hussain Khan, one of the legends of the Rampur Sahaswan Gharana. He had a rare mastery over taal and tarana, a speciality of his gharana. His effortless slide on the three octaves was striking. In this album, he has sung Raga Lalit, Jaiajaiwanti and Basant recorded in 1971 and 1972.

Sitar maestro Pandit Nikhil Banerjee was revered for his celestial quality of music. He was a student of Acharya Allaudin Khan of the Maihar Gharana. His strokes were brilliant and carried a resounding beauty. The album features Raga Megh, Malkauns,

Sohoni, Mishra Gara and a Baul Dhun, all recorded between 1966 and 1972. Technological advances are indeed a boon for the music industry. By filtering unwanted noises in the original recordings, technology has enhanced the quality of the original recordings.

There is an element of mystique about the ghazal queen, Begum Akhtar. Her attitude towards romanticism and life was unique. Her style and approach to music were natural and spontaneous. It was steeped in pathos but not helplessness. The pathos of one who dared to love, lose and suffer. The album opens with all-time ghazal *Aye mohabbat* followed by thumries and dadras like *Hamar kahin mano rajaji*, *Hamari Atariya pe aao*. Truly a must-have.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit



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BEGUM AKHTAR

